

Europe's rail system prepares for war

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【要点】

- ・ 欧州は民間鉄道網を有事の際に軍隊と軍事装備の輸送に活用する方法を検討しており、インフラの脆弱性や国境手続きの遅さなど複数の課題に対処している。
- ・ 欧州委員会は橋などの瓶首箇所の特定と改善、軍事列車の迅速な越境を可能にする規則改正という2つの施策を推進している。
- ・ 数十年の間に専用軍事鉄道輸送力が減少し、民間事業者への依存が高まったため、有事の際に利用可能な鉄道車両の確保が課題となっている。
- ・ NATOの調達機関は医療列車、寝台客車、燃料タンク車、低床ワゴンなど様々な車両の確保をメーカーと協議している。
- ・ 自動車メーカーが産業加速化法における規制除外を求めてEU機関へロビー活動を行っている。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By JORDYN DAHL with MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — Europe is trying to work out how

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

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with MARTINA SAPIO

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SNEAK PEEK

— Europe is trying to work out how its civilian rail network would move troops and military equipment in a crisis, Martina finds out at Berlin's InnoTrans show.

— Automakers on both sides of the English Channel are lobbying the EU institutions for carve-outs in the Industrial Accelerator Act.

— The TRAN Committee will scrutinize the Commission's passenger package this fall, with a vote penciled in for next spring.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

Tips to jdahl@politico.eu , tlecca@politico.eu and msapio@politico.eu . Follow us @tommylecca , @jordyndahl and @martsapio .

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DRIVING THE DAY

EUROPE'S RAILWAYS PREPARE FOR WAR: Europe is trying to work out how its civilian rail network would move troops and military equipment in a crisis. At InnoTrans in Berlin, the Commission, NATO, the European Union Agency for Railways and industry officials focused on everything from weak bridges and slow border procedures to a shortage of suitable wagons and the need to secure civilian capacity before an emergency.

Two tracks in Brussels: DG MOVE's Eric von Breska said the Commission is working on two streams. The first is infrastructure: identifying bridges and other bottlenecks that cannot handle heavier military trains and figuring out where upgrades are needed. The second is rules: cutting the time needed for diplomatic clearances, train-path allocation and vehicle authorizations so military trains can move across borders quickly. The Commission's military mobility proposal , which tackles many of the same issues, is now in trilogue negotiations, but political sticking points remain — including its emergency mechanism and a proposed solidarity pool of transport assets.

Not enough trains: Brussels is also trying to work out what rolling stock countries could actually call on in an emergency — from flatbed wagons and passenger coaches to other specialized vehicles — after decades in which dedicated military rail capacity shrank and governments became increasingly reliant on civilian operators.

NATO goes to industry: Jorge Lopez with NATO's Support and Procurement Agency listed medical trains, sleeping coaches, fuel tanks and low-bed wagons among the capabilities the alliance wants to explore with industry. He said he had spent the past six months speaking to more than 100 civilian rail companies about what capacity they could make available to NATO.

Its own forum: One concrete ask from NATO was for a dedicated military mobility working group within the European Union Agency for Railways, bringing military planners together with regulators and rail experts so requirements such as heavier and taller vehicles can feed directly into future technical discussions. The agency said closer cooperation was welcome.

Pick up the phone: Train-maker Stadler's Catharina Dohmeier said her "hardest challenge" has been identifying "the guy or the woman who is able and willing to take a decision" after discussions with companies and governments — underlining the coordination problem Europe needs to solve before its railways can work at military speed.

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CARS

AUTO LOBBIES POKE HOLES IN IAA: Automakers on both sides of the English Channel are lobbying the EU institutions for carveouts in the Industrial Accelerator Act. U.K. auto lobby SMMT wants to ensure its automakers qualify as Made in Europe. ACEA — the EU auto lobby — published a new report this week that argues there is not enough battery capacity in the bloc to meet the proposed local content requirements.

Reminder: The EU institutions are negotiating the IAA. The Commission proposal would initially require three main battery components to originate in Europe, rising to five after three years. POLITICO reported earlier this month that ACEA wants the first battery requirements to be delayed by three years with the expanded requirements delayed to five years.

Bottleneck: Europe let its battery champion — Sweden's Northvolt — go bankrupt in 2025 . Smaller companies are producing batteries, but the bulk of production is done by South Korean or Chinese companies. That's not the biggest problem in getting European supply, however. The analysis from ACEA says the bottleneck is further upstream with the materials needed to make battery cells, one of three components the Commission says must be sourced in Europe.

Chinese dominance: Without those materials, batteries manufactured in the EU would still require imported cathodes and anodes that are predominantly produced in China.

Flexibility needed: Beyond delaying the battery requirements, ACEA says the IAA needs to help build the EU's upstream materials industry. Otherwise, policymakers risk leaving suppliers unable to meet the local content requirements and EU-produced electric vehicles won't qualify for public subsidies.

Investment at risk: The SMMT, meanwhile, says the EU-U.K. automotive trading relationship is worth an annual €80 billion. The U.K. is the biggest importer of European automotive components, a report commissioned by the lobby found . The U.K. automotive sector — which exports the bulk of its vehicles to the EU — supports 250,000 jobs across the bloc, the analysis found.

Let us in: The lobby is hoping the numbers will help sway policymakers in the EU to ensure the U.K. is included in the Made in Europe club. It has allies in the Parliament and Council, with Germany pushing to include the U.K. among other closely integrated economies like Norway and Switzerland.

Corporate fleets: In the Commission's automotive package, member states must hit electrification targets for corporate fleets, which make up 60% of sales in the EU. The risk for U.K. automakers is their cars would be locked out of the scheme.

VOLKSWAGEN SHIFTING PRODUCTION AT WOLFSBURG: The German automaker is reducing the number of combustion engine vehicles it produces at its main plant in Wolfsburg, according to a report from Automobilwoche . VW is canceling extra shifts for combustion models and instead switching to electric vehicle production as demand for them increases, Sales Director Martin Sander told the outlet.

CARMAKER PROFITABILITY FALLS IN CHINA: China's EV price war is squeezing margins, with prices down nearly 14% in the first quarter and sector profitability at just 2.9%, according to the latest European Chamber of Commerce in China report . The pressure is spilling into Europe, where suppliers warn of growing Chinese competition and car party lobby CLEPA is backing local-content requirements for publicly funded vehicles.

RAIL

EXCLUSIVE — PASSENGER PACKAGE MOVES INTO PARLIAMENT: The TRAN Committee is mapping out its work on the Commission's new passenger package, according to an internal timetable seen by Martina, with detailed scrutiny starting this fall and a committee vote penciled in for the spring.

Three files, three rapporteurs: S&D's Daniel Attard is leading on multimodal booking, Renew's Jan-Christoph Oetjen on passenger protection for single tickets, and Greens MEP Kai Tegethoff on rail ticketing.

What the package does: The Commission's May proposal is built around the idea of making it easier to plan and buy cross-border rail journeys involving several operators, and make sure passenger rights apply across the whole trip. Brussels wants travelers to be able to compare and buy combined services from different rail companies in one transaction, while getting assistance, rerouting, reimbursement and compensation if they miss a connection on a protected single-ticket journey.

Booking rules too: The package would also impose new obligations on ticketing platforms and rail operators, including fair access to ticket sales and more neutral presentation of travel options, while pushing for commercial agreements between platforms and operators on fair and non-discriminatory terms.

The timetable: TRAN held an initial exchange with the Commission in early September, which will be followed by a technical briefing later this month. The draft reports are expected to be presented in December, with the deadline for amendments also falling that month.

Then the real bargaining starts: At least four technical meetings are set for winter, followed by consideration of amendments and an IMCO opinion. The TRAN vote is currently scheduled for early spring, with a plenary announcement expected in April.

BRUSSELS PUSHES RAIL THROUGH GLOBAL GATEWAY: Ursula von der Leyen used her State of the Union speech to announce a new Middle Corridor push linking the South Caucasus and Central Asia more directly to Europe. Now, Commission officials at InnoTrans in Berlin set out how Brussels wants to turn the Global Gateway into a more practical rail-investment tool. They also signed a new agreement with the European Union Agency for Railways to help do it.

ERA goes global: The Commission and ERA signed a €5 million, four-year cooperation agreement covering partner countries in Africa, Asia and Latin America. ERA will provide technical assistance on safety, interoperability, regulation, ERTMS and technical standards, while adapting European experience to local conditions rather than simply exporting EU rules wholesale.

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